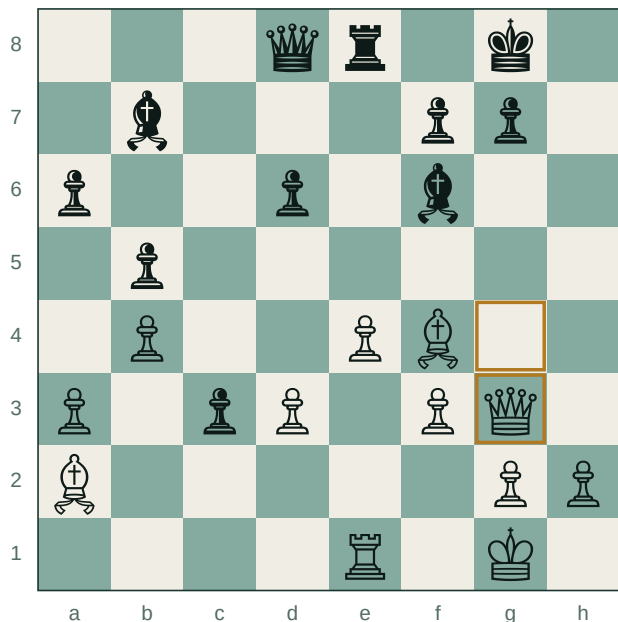


Skewers: Black, move 21

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Qg3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Bh4 22. Qg4 Bxe1

21...Bh4 The bishop moves from f6 to h4. Recorded reply: **22.Qg4**.

22...Bxe1 The bishop captures the rook on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on a2. Check for tactical protection.